PRISMA 2020 Audit Report

Systematic Review: Antimicrobial Peptides in Marine Teleosts

Author: Álvaro Hernández Montiel

Institution: UABC / CICESE
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Document purpose: Internal audit documenting all numerical discrepancies, methodological clarifications, and resolutions identified during the preparation of the PRISMA 2020 flow diagram for the systematic review.

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1 Revision History

Version 1.1 — October 10

This revision incorporates findings from an extended audit of the search strategy and de-duplication pipeline. Six discrepancies are now documented (four resolved in v1.0, two added in v1.1).

2 Executive Summary

The audit identified and resolved **six numerical discrepancies**:

(1) Exclusion count inconsistency (**263 vs. 264**)

(2) E6 category over-count (44 vs. 43)

(3) Full-text exclusions (2 vs. 4 studies)

(4) Final included studies (26 vs. 24)

(5) De-duplication criterion sensitivity (287 vs. 291 vs. 294)

(6) Risk of Bias distribution (17/5/2 confirmed)

Final verified numbers: 399 → 291 → 263 excluded → 28 eligible → 4 excluded → **24 included**

3 Search Strategy Verification

3.1 Four-Track Search Strategy

Four complementary boolean searches were conducted in Scopus.

3.2 Records Retrieved per Track

Search Track	Records
Track A original	100
Track B original	99
Track A refined	100
Track B refined	100
Total	**399**

4 PRISMA Flow: Verified Numbers

Final Verification

$83 + 54 + 43 + 41 + 33 + 9 = 263$
$263 + 2 + 26 = 291$
$28 - 4 = 24$

PRISMA Stage	Number
Records identified	399
Duplicates removed	108
Unique records screened	291
Records excluded	263
Full-text assessed	28
Full-text excluded	4
Included in synthesis	**24**

5 Identified Discrepancies and Resolutions

5.1 Discrepancy 1: Exclusion Count (263 vs. 264)

Resolution: The actual count of EXCLUDE records was **263**, not 264.

5.2 Discrepancy 2: E6 Category Over-Count (44 vs. 43)

Resolution: Traced to a single record (Xue et al., 2026) that was classified as MAYBE but had a residual E6 tag. Verified count: 43.

5.3 Discrepancy 3: Full-Text Exclusions (2 vs. 4)

Resolution: Additional exclusions identified: Miccoli et al. (2021) and Wang et al. (2024) failed C2. Total: 4.

5.4 Discrepancy 4: Final Included Studies (26 vs. 24)

Resolution: $28 - 4 = 24$ studies.

5.5 Discrepancy 5: De-Duplication Criterion (287 vs. 291 vs. 294)

Resolution: Union-find over (exact DOI) $\cup$ (fuzzy title $\geq 78\%$) reproduces 291 exactly.

5.6 Discrepancy 6: Risk of Bias (17/5/2)

Resolution: Direct count from Table S2 after removing Miccoli and Wang confirmed 17 Low / 5 Minor / 2 Moderate.

6 Conclusion

The PRISMA 2020 audit identified and resolved all six discrepancies. Final verified flow:

399 → 291 → 263 excluded → 28 eligible → 4 excluded → 24 included

End of Audit Report